

Lecture 1: Linear Transformations & Matrices

Date: 2026-08-10
Reading: Chapter 2
Duration: 75 minutes
Difficulty: Intermediate

Core Definitions

We begin by establishing the properties of fields mapping vector components.

Definition 1.1 : Linear Map

A function $T : V \rightarrow W$ between two vector spaces over the same field F is called a **linear transformation** if it satisfies:

1. Additivity: $T(u + v) = T(u) + T(v)$ for all $u, v \in V$
2. Homogeneity: $T(cv) = cT(v)$ for all $c \in F$ and $v \in V$

Definition 1.2 : Vector Space

...

Fundamental Theorems

Theorem 1.3 : Rank-Nullity Theorem

Let V and W be vector spaces, where V is finite-dimensional. If $T : V \rightarrow W$ is a linear map, then:

$$\dim(\text{null } T) + \dim(\text{range } T) = \dim V$$

Homework Practice

Exercise 1.4 : Identity Dimension Mapping

Let $T : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be defined by $T(x, y, z) = (x + y, z)$. Find a structured matrix representation M_T and verify the output dimension explicitly:

$$M_T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Exercise 1.5 : Identity Dimension Mapping

Let $T : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be defined by $T(x, y, z) = (x + y, z)$. Find the dimension of the null space.

Solution:

By inspecting the matrix row parameters:

$$M_T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

The rank is clearly 2 because the two rows are linearly independent. By Rank-Nullity, $\dim(\text{null } T) = 3 - 2 = 1$.

Note 1.6

Remember that every basis is linearly independent.

Warning 1.7

Do **not** confuse image and codomain.

Example 1.8

Let

$$T(x, y) = (x + y, y).$$

Proof.

We proceed by induction...

□

Remark 1.9

The converse is false.

History 1.10

The Rank-Nullity theorem appeared in the nineteenth century.

Lemma 1.11

lemma statement

Proposition 1.12

proposition statement

Claim 1.13

claim statement

Corollary 1.14

corollary statement